Problem #4: Turkish News and Conversations (15 marks)

Read this account of some interactions between three Turkish speakers: A, B and C. The account is mostly in English, with Turkish sentences quoted verbatim in some places.

> A had told B that the king was sick, so B said to C, "**Kral hastaymış.**" To this C objected and said it was not the king who was sick, but the minister. He had seen that the minister was sick. So C said, "**Bakan hastaydı.**" After this, C goes home, and A joins B.
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> A and B talk about the town center which was demolished. A is too young to have seen the town center so B tells him that it was old: "**Şehir merkezi eskiydi,**" he said. After that, B invited A to his house on the 18th of May, but he said he wasn't available that day, but he was available a day before that, "**17 Mayıs'ta müsait değilim**". B also went and invited C.
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> When A, B and C met on 17th May, A told C, "**Şehir merkezi eskiymiş**" and also that the minister is recovering now: "**Bakan şu an iyileşiyor**". He further said that the minister was seen earlier, "**Daha önce görüldü**"

Now, consider small excerpts from two news reports in Turkish. They are reporting the same event(s). One of these reports is based on the other one, i.e., one of them was written earlier and the other report used the original one as a basis. Your task is to determine which is the original report. As always, justify your answer. Also, translate as much of the reports as you can. There will be portions which you cannot translate; you can put ellipses (...) for them and translate whatever else you can.

Report 1:

> **Bakan yorum yapmaya müsait değilmiş. Daha önce hastaymış, şu an iyileşiyor. 12 Mart'ta şehir merkezinde görülmüş.**

Report 2:

> **Bakan en son 12 Mart'ta şehir merkezinde görüldü. Gazetemiz ona ulaşmaya çalıştığında yorum yapmaya müsait değildi. Daha önce hastaydı, şu an iyileşiyor.**

Turkish belongs to the Turkic language family. It is spoken in Turkey and within smaller communities in many other countries. It is the mother tongue of more than 63 million people.
Note that i and ı are distinct letters.

– Yash Sinha & Atınç çağan şengül